YIFEI SUN

Principal Software Engineer · AI Automation & Platform Architecture · 13 Years

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SUMMARY

Principal-level backend & platform engineer with 13 years building distributed systems and shipping LLM-powered applications to production. Recent work centers on agentic AI — designing an MCP server with tool-calling orchestration for ChatGPT integration, and building an AI automation platform with evaluation, multi-provider LLM support, and configurable policy frameworks. Track record of standing up greenfield platforms from day 1, defining primitives and orchestration layers that scale across organizations, and driving cross-functional alignment across 10+ teams. Thrives in ambiguous, high-impact 0→1 environments.

LEADERSHIP HIGHLIGHTS

- Shipped LLM-powered agent systems to production: MCP tool-calling server, AI evaluation harness, multi-provider orchestration
- Led cross-org platform initiatives spanning 10+ engineering teams across 3 departments
- Built greenfield platforms from day 1 — defined primitives, APIs, and orchestration patterns adopted org-wide
- Mentored senior engineers toward Principal-level scope; drove architectural standards via RFCs and design docs

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, Python, Node.js · OpenAI/ChatGPT, MCP Protocol, LLM Orchestration, Agent Evaluation · AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Kafka, Redis, PostgreSQL · GraphQL (Netflix DGS), Microservices, Event-Driven, CQRS · Datadog, Grafana · Keycloak, SSO, OAuth 2.0

INDEPENDENT PROJECT

GenAI Automation Platform & Evaluation System

- Architected an agentic AI platform with hybrid rules + multi-path LLM inference (fast vs. deep), policy overlay, and tool-calling orchestration — producing explainable, grounded recommendations over heterogeneous data sources.
- Built an evaluation harness ("Prompt Lab") for end-to-end simulation, offline backtesting, hallucination detection, and prompt/parameter search (grid & Bayesian optimization) with observability and multi-provider LLM support.
- Designed a configurable policy framework with DB-backed configs, environment-specific overrides, and a scheduler-driven tuning loop — enabling safe, iterative improvement of AI-driven automation without manual intervention.

EXPERIENCE

CarGurus — Principal Software Engineer / Technical Lead Oct 2019 – Present

ChatGPT Apps SDK MCP Server — Agentic Tool Calling (0→1)

- Sole backend engineer designing and implementing an MCP server compatible with the OpenAI Apps SDK, enabling ChatGPT agents to autonomously invoke CarGurus capabilities via structured tool calls — defining tool schemas, orchestration logic, and request/response contracts.
- Shipped to production under high ambiguity; iterated rapidly with PMs and directors on tool definitions and agent behavior; designed for safe, incremental rollout alongside existing APIs and clients.
- Served as key engineering representative for AI agent strategy, shaping the technical roadmap for agentic AI integration across the company.

High-Traffic Platform Modernization — Orchestration & Automation

- Led 3 principal/senior engineers and partnered with ~10 teams across 3 departments to redesign the core platform behind CarGurus' most-visited page (~8,000 rpm, millions of daily impressions).
- Introduced a new orchestration service consolidating 12 downstream integrations into 5 well-defined services — defining the primitives, orchestration layer, and tools that enabled teams across the org to build on top of the platform.
- Produced initial architecture in ~2 weeks; shipped first milestone in 6 months; completed ahead of schedule.

p99: 250 ms → 50 ms (5×) **Availability: 98% → 99.9%** **Deploy: 1 hr → 3 min** (20×)

GraphQL Federation — Unified Serving Layer

- Designed and integrated a Netflix DGS subgraph into CarGurus' federated GraphQL gateway, creating a unified API layer for frontend, backend, and AI agent consumers from a single graph.

- Implemented schema federation, batch data loaders (N+1 prevention), and JVM warmup strategies; built load tests and staging integration tests for production-grade reliability.

Digital Commerce Platform — 0→1 Under Ambiguity

- Led backend design and launch of multiple greenfield products using microservice and event-driven architecture; enabled the company to rapidly test, launch, and safely retire product experiments without destabilizing core systems.

Cross-Org Platform Leadership & Automation Standards

- Defined platform primitives and architectural standards — API design, caching, distributed orchestration — adopted across multiple teams via RFCs and design docs; built parity-testing framework for safe, automated migration validation.
- Mentored senior engineers on system design, performance, and path to Principal-level scope.

Applause — Senior Software Engineer / Technical Lead

Oct 2017 – Oct 2019

Authentication & Identity Platform

- Upgraded legacy authentication to a modern Keycloak-based SSO platform, unifying auth across internal systems, an enterprise partner platform, and a large external community. Migrated multiple Angular, Node.js, and Java monoliths behind the new auth gateway with minimal downtime.

Event Sourcing & CQRS Platform Initiative

- Drove design and prototyping of a microservice architecture based on event sourcing and CQRS; defined foundational patterns for services, events, and read/write models adopted by new domains.

Cross-Org Collaboration — Customer Support & Workflow Automation

- Partnered with product, support, and customer-facing teams to modernize internal workflows and enterprise integrations with clear observability and rollback paths.

Toast Inc. — Senior Software Engineer

Sep 2014 – Oct 2017

Monolith → Microservices Decomposition

- Among the earliest engineers during hypergrowth; designed and implemented core backend services (Order Service, Labor Service, foundational APIs) that became the platform other teams built upon.
- Built initial AWS deployment pipelines and automated testing framework, enabling safer releases during rapid product expansion.

Third-Party Integrations & Cross-Functional Leadership

- Led integrations with key partners, ensuring reliable bidirectional sync and schema evolution. Partnered with PMs, sales, and support to translate customer feedback into platform capabilities.

The MathWorks Inc. — Software Engineer II

Jul 2013 – Aug 2014

Developed internal engineering tools for MATLAB/Simulink workflows. Improved backend automation systems for build/test reliability and developer productivity.

EDUCATION

M.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering — Northeastern University, Boston 2010 – 2013

B.S. in Information Science — Beijing University of Aeronautics and Astronautics 2006 – 2010